

Section A – Vocabulary (Questions 1–20)

1. The word drought most nearly means –

- (a) a long period without rain (b) a gentle breeze
(c) a sudden snowfall (d) a volcanic eruption

3. Land that slowly turns into desert because it loses its plants and moisture is said to suffer from ____.

- (a) conservation (b) irrigation (c) desertification (d) recycling

5. A synonym for mitigate, as in mitigate the effects of the flood, is –

- (a) increase (b) celebrate (c) reduce (d) publish

7. Vulnerable, as in vulnerable areas, is closest in meaning to –

- (a) easily harmed (b) completely protected (c) highly polluted (d) deeply hidden

9. The opposite of scarcity, as in scarcity of water, is –

- (a) shortage (b) abundance (c) drought (d) famine

11. A synonym for contaminate is –

- (a) purify (b) filter (c) preserve (d) pollute

13. A method that can be continued without damaging the environment and without running out of resources is described as ____.

- (a) wasteful (b) sustainable (c) sudden (d) obsolete

15. Replenish, as in replenish the groundwater, means to –

- (a) fill again (b) use up (c) block off (d) dry out

17. Farmers plant trees to ____ the soil against erosion.

- (a) anchor (b) pour (c) flatten (d) burn

19. A fragile ecosystem is one that is –

- (a) easily damaged (b) extremely large (c) fully protected (d) newly formed

2. Deforestation refers to –

- (a) replanting trees in a bare area (b) cutting down forests on a large scale (c) watering dry farmland (d) protecting rare animals

4. The opposite of barren, as in barren land, is –

- (a) rocky (b) fertile (c) sandy (d) dusty

6. Soil erosion means –

- (a) the enrichment of the soil with minerals (b) the planting of new forests (c) the wearing away of soil by wind or water (d) the freezing of soil in winter

8. A sediment carried by a river is –

- (a) a wall that holds back water (b) a sudden rise in the river level (c) sand and mud deposited by water (d) plants growing in a pond

10. A landslide is best described as –

- (a) the eruption of a volcano (b) a storm far out at sea (c) the slow drying of a lake (d) the sudden sliding of rock and soil down a slope

12. Earthquakes occur when the Earth's plates suddenly ____ along a fault.

- (a) float (b) evaporate (c) revolve (d) slip

14. Areas prone to flooding are areas that are –

- (a) protected from flooding (b) far from any water (c) likely to be flooded (d) surprised by heavy rain

16. A ____ climate receives very little rain throughout the year.

- (a) humid (b) mild (c) stormy (d) arid

18. A smaller earthquake that follows a larger one is called a(n) ____.

- (a) aftershock (b) outburst (c) uplift (d) upwind

20. The severe storm ____ the coastline.

- (a) repaired (b) inspected (c) devastated (d) photographed

Section B – Grammar and Functions (Questions 21–32)

21. Water ____ at 100 degrees Celsius.

(a) boiling (b) boil (c) boiled (d) boils

23. First, heavy rain soaked the ground. ____, the water began to flow downhill. Finally, it flooded the village.

(a) Again (b) Last (c) Next (d) Sometimes

25. ____ it stops raining soon, the crops will fail.

(a) Although (b) So (c) Unless (d) Because

27. You ____ not drink floodwater, as it may be polluted.

(a) are going to (b) had better (c) keep on (d) was able to

29. Hot, dry winds dried the plants, ____ they could not produce grain.

(a) or (b) so (c) because (d) but

31. To reduce smoke, you ____ burn plastic, which releases harmful gases.

(a) should not (b) must (c) should (d) will

22. The Earth ____ around the Sun.

(a) revolving (b) revolves (c) revolve (d) revolved

24. The trees were cut down quickly; ____, the soil was washed away by the rain.

(a) however (b) for example (c) in addition (d) as a result

26. The river flooded ____ the heavy rains.

(a) instead of (b) on behalf of (c) in spite of (d) because of

28. The villagers built new houses on higher ground ____ the flood destroyed their old ones.

(a) before (b) unless (c) after (d) although

30. Every year, floods in this region ____ away the topsoil.

(a) washes (b) to wash (c) washing (d) wash

32. ____, smoke enters the air; then it mixes with moisture; finally, it falls as acid rain.

(a) First (b) Next (c) Finally (d) Later

Section C – Reading Comprehension (Questions 33–50)

Read the following passage carefully, then answer questions 33–38.

Forests protect the soil. Their roots hold the soil together, and their leaves break the force of falling rain. When people cut down trees without planting new ones, the soil has no protection. Rain washes the loose soil into rivers, and the rivers carry it away. Land that was once rich becomes poor and bare. In time, this land may turn into desert. To prevent this, communities plant new trees and control tree cutting carefully.

33. According to the passage, what do the roots of trees do?

(a) They break the force of the rain. (b) They hold the soil together. (c) They make the soil loose. (d) They fill the rivers.

35. What is the main effect of cutting down trees without planting new ones?

(a) The soil is washed away by rain. (b) The rivers become cleaner. (c) The birds return to the forest. (d) The area receives more snow.

37. According to the passage, what do communities do to stop land from turning into desert?

(a) They plant new trees. (b) They pour sand on the fields. (c) They remove the rivers. (d) They burn the old trees.

34. According to the passage, what do the leaves of trees do?

(a) They break the force of falling rain. (b) They make the weather colder. (c) They help the roots to float. (d) They stop the rivers from flowing.

36. The main idea of the passage is that —

(a) planting crops is more important than keeping forests. (b) forests protect the soil, and cutting them damages the land. (c) rivers should be filled with soil. (d) desertification affects only people.

38. The word 'bare' in the passage most nearly means —

(a) without plants or cover (b) full of water (c) full of green grass (d) extremely steep

Read the following passage carefully, then answer questions 39–44.

Floods happen when too much water covers land that is usually dry. Heavy and continuous rain is the most common cause. When rain falls faster than the ground and the rivers can absorb it, the water rises and spreads over roads, fields, and houses. Floods can destroy homes and crops, and floodwater often carries diseases. People in flood-prone areas are encouraged to keep important documents in high places, prepare emergency bags, and follow the warnings of their local government.

39. According to the passage, what is the most common cause of floods?

(a) The movement of large ships. (b) Melting snow in autumn. (c) Heavy and continuous rain. (d) Strong wind in summer.

41. The passage says floodwater is dangerous to health because —

(a) it is too salty. (b) it is very hot. (c) it often carries diseases. (d) it is too clear.

43. The word 'absorb' in the passage is closest in meaning to —

(a) push away (b) pour out (c) blow up (d) soak up

40. According to the passage, a flood occurs when —

(a) the rivers dry up completely. (b) too much water covers land that is usually dry. (c) the sea becomes too salty. (d) plants absorb all the rainwater.

42. According to the passage, people in flood-prone areas should —

(a) ignore government warnings. (b) keep documents in high places and prepare emergency bags. (c) drink floodwater every day. (d) remove trees from the valley.

44. Which of the following is TRUE according to the passage?

(a) Floodwater always helps crops grow. (b) Floods can destroy homes and crops. (c) The ground can absorb any amount of rain instantly. (d) Floods never damage property.

Read the following passage carefully, then answer questions 45–50.

An earthquake is the sudden shaking of the ground caused by the movement of rocks deep inside the Earth. The most powerful shaking usually lasts only seconds, yet it can damage or knock down buildings. During an earthquake, experts advise you to drop to the ground, take cover under a strong table, and hold on until the shaking stops. After the shaking ends, leave the building carefully and move to an open area, away from walls and power lines.

45. According to the passage, what causes an earthquake?

(a) The movement of rocks deep inside the Earth. (b) The heat of the summer sun. (c) Strong winds over the ocean. (d) The flooding of nearby rivers.

47. What does the passage advise you to do DURING an earthquake?

(a) Drop to the ground, take cover under a strong table, and hold on. (b) Stand beside a tall window. (c) Run out into the middle of the road. (d) Climb a high power line.

49. The phrase 'knock down' in the passage is closest in meaning to —

46. According to the passage, how long does the most powerful shaking usually last?

(a) several weeks (b) a full day (c) only seconds (d) a whole month

48. According to the passage, after the shaking stops you should —

(a) return to the building at once. (b) move to an open area away from walls and power lines. (c) stay under the table for a long time. (d) switch on all the lights.

50. The best title for this passage is —

(a) build (b) destroy (c) paint (d) measure

(a) "The Best Crops for Dry Land" (b) "How People Live near the Sea" (c) "Staying Safe during an Earthquake" (d) "The Benefits of Heavy Rain"

Section D – General Comprehension (Questions 51–60)

51. Which of the following is a natural environmental hazard?

(a) An earthquake (b) A new highway (c) Recycling paper (d) Planting a garden

53. Which of the following can cause desertification?

(a) Constant fog (b) Frequent heavy snow (c) Building large dams (d) Overgrazing and cutting down trees

55. Which is the best way to prevent landslides on a steep slope?

(a) Pouring oil on the slope (b) Cutting away all plants (c) Planting trees and grasses with strong roots (d) Building heavy houses on the slope

57. Why is clean drinking water important during and after a flood?

(a) Clean water makes rivers rise. (b) Clean water is very expensive. (c) Floodwater may carry germs. (d) Clean water removes crops.

59. Which of the following is a good way to conserve water during a drought?

(a) Leaving taps running (b) Watering fields at noon (c) Letting pipes leak (d) Using a bucket rather than a hose to water plants

52. Which human activity is a major cause of deforestation?

(a) Protecting wild animals (b) Planting new trees (c) Clearing forests for farmland (d) Building birdhouses

54. Air pollution is mainly caused by –

(a) replanting forests. (b) burning fuel and releasing industrial gases. (c) keeping rivers clean. (d) protecting grasslands.

56. If a farmer cuts down trees on a hillside, the most likely result is –

(a) richer soil. (b) soil erosion downhill. (c) more rainfall. (d) larger harvests.

58. Which weather condition most directly causes a drought?

(a) Heavy snow all year (b) Thick fog every day (c) Strong winds at sea (d) Very little or no rain for a long time

60. Burning waste is harmful to people because –

(a) the smoke makes the ground wet. (b) the smoke contains gases that are bad to breathe. (c) the smoke cools the air. (d) the smoke helps plants grow.